



Mainstream Commodities

Definition:

Widely produced, consumed, and traded across global or national markets.

Key Traits:

- **High demand** across multiple industries.
- **Standardised** quality (e.g., 99.9% pure copper, Grade A wheat).
- **Traded on major exchanges** (MCX, LME, CBOT, ICE, etc.).
- **High liquidity** — easy to buy/sell in bulk.
- **Stable, global pricing** influenced by supply-demand, geopolitics, weather, etc.

Examples:

Crude oil, gold, wheat, copper, aluminium, natural gas, cotton, sugar, iron ore.

Use Case:

Core building blocks of global trade and industry.



Niche Commodities

Definition:

Specialised, emerging, or region-specific materials with **limited but high-value demand**.

Key Traits:

- **Low trade volume** but **high per-unit value** or specialised use.
- Often **innovative, sustainable, or regionally sourced**.
- **Not standardised** — quality or origin can differ greatly.
- **Limited liquidity** — harder to find buyers/sellers.
- Markets often **off-exchange** or **contract-based**.

Examples:

Zeolites from fly ash, rare earth elements, lithium, biochar, activated carbon, organic compost, bagasse ash, or industrial by-products used in green tech.

Use Case:

Targeted industries — e.g., renewable energy, filtration, fertilisers, high-tech, EV batteries.

 In Short

Feature	Mainstream Commodity	Niche Commodity
Market Size	Large / Global	Small / Specialized
Liquidity	High	Low
Trading Platform	Public Exchanges	Private / Contract-based
Pricing	Standardized	Custom / Negotiated
Example	Crude Oil, Gold, Wheat	Biochar, Zeolite, Lithium, Compost

Common commodity List (Mainstream)

 Agricultural Commodities

Food Grains

- Wheat
- Corn (Maize)
- Rice (Paddy)
- Barley
- Oats
- Sorghum

Oilseeds & Oils

- Soybeans
- Soybean Oil
- Soybean Meal
- Mustard Seed
- Rapeseed
- Sunflower Seed
- Palm Oil
- Groundnut (Peanut)
- Cottonseed Oil

Soft Commodities (Plantation Crops)

- Sugar (Raw / White)
- Coffee (Arabica / Robusta)
- Cocoa
- Cotton
- Tea
- Rubber (Natural Rubber)
- Tobacco

Spices & Others (India-specific and regional)

- Turmeric
- Black Pepper
- Cardamom (Small & Large)
- Cumin (Jeera)
- Coriander
- Chilli

Livestock & Animal Products

- Live Cattle
- Feeder Cattle
- Lean Hogs (Pork)
- Poultry (Broilers, Eggs)
- Dairy (Milk, Butter, Cheese, Skimmed Milk Powder)

Energy Commodities

Crude & Refined Products

- Crude Oil (WTI, Brent, Dubai)
- Natural Gas (Henry Hub, LNG)
- Gasoline (Petrol)
- Diesel (Heating Oil)
- Jet Fuel (ATF)
- Naphtha
- LPG / Propane / Butane

Coal & Alternatives

- Thermal Coal
- Coking Coal (Met Coal)
- Biofuels (Ethanol, Biodiesel)

Metals

Base Metals (Industrial)

- Aluminium

- Copper
- Zinc
- Lead
- Nickel
- Tin

Precious Metals

- Gold
- Silver
- Platinum
- Palladium
- Rhodium

Ferrous Metals (Steel-related)

- Iron Ore
- Steel (Rebar, HRC – Hot Rolled Coil)
- Stainless Steel
- Pig Iron / Sponge Iron
- Ferroalloys (Fe-Mn, Fe-Si, Fe-Cr, Fe-Mo, etc.)

Construction & Industrial Commodities

- Cement
- Clinker
- Limestone
- Gypsum
- Aggregates (Sand, Gravel)

- Bitumen / Asphalt

Non-Metallic Minerals

- Silica Sand
- Bentonite Clay
- Kaolin
- Bauxite
- Phosphate Rock
- Potash
- Sulphur
- Talc
- Feldspar

Energy Transition / Strategic Commodities

(Used in batteries, EVs, renewable energy, etc.)

- Lithium
- Cobalt
- Graphite
- Manganese (High Purity)
- Rare Earth Elements (Neodymium, Dysprosium, etc.)
- Uranium
- Thorium
- Hydrogen (as a traded molecule in future markets)

Environmental & Carbon Commodities

- Carbon Credits (CER, VER)
- Renewable Energy Certificates (REC)
- Water Rights (in some markets)

Organic / Biomass Commodities

- Organic Compost
- Biochar
- Bagasse
- Molasses
- Wood Pellets
- Sawdust Briquettes

Miscellaneous / Niche Commodities

- Salt
- Soda Ash
- Activated Carbon
- Silicates
- Zeolites
- Fly Ash / Bottom Ash
- Rare Industrial Gases (Helium, Argon, Neon, etc.)

Which ever commodity is not mentioned here is Niche commodity.